

Activity Résumé Builder

FOR THE STUDENT

Everything you have done, written down properly, before you have to squeeze it into the Common App’s ten slots and 150 characters. Most students undersell themselves because they cannot remember.

When: Junior year — then keep adding to it

For each activity

Do one block per activity. Hours and weeks matter — colleges ask for them.

Activity	Your role	Grades involved	Hrs/week	Weeks/year	What you actually did

Things students forget to count

Tick anything true, then go back and add it above.

- ☐ Paid work of any kind, including informal jobs
- ☐ Caring for a sibling or a relative
- ☐ Translating for family members
- ☐ Religious or community service
- ☐ Teaching yourself something serious (coding, an instrument, a language)
- ☐ Running a household task nobody else does
- ☐ Online communities you help run
- ☐ Family business you work in

The 150-character version

Rewrite your top five so each fits in the Common App box. Verbs first, results second.

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ Caring for family is an activity. It shows more than most clubs do.
- ◆ "Led", "built", "raised", "taught" beat "participated in" every time.
- ◆ Numbers are free: how many people, how much money, how many hours.